



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Classical School

School Website: <https://veritasclassicalschool.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Veritas Classical School Florida (St. Augustine, FL 32084) presents a robust classical Christian program organized around the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) with explicit commitments to a biblical worldview, virtue formation, and engagement with Great Books within an integrated curriculum. Public materials from the school's website emphasize Christ-centered formation, a two-campus grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, and a mission to cultivate truth, goodness, and beauty through a classical education rooted in faith. The school repeatedly frames itself as a classical Christian institution with three distinct educational phases and a clear stance on faith-integrated pedagogy, including chapel participation and family partnership. Evidence across pages such as the Mission and Christian Education sections, the Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric structure, and references to accreditation and faculty supports a strong Classical orientation with explicit religious foundations. The aggregate assessment across the six classical elements is CLASSICAL.

Key inflection points - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are explicit: biblical worldview; Christ-centered pedagogy; weekly chapel; the fear of the LORD as the starting point for wisdom; theology integrated into curriculum. - Purpose and Goal emphasize formation and moral imagination over mere job preparation; a teleology oriented to truth, goodness, and beauty. - Curriculum centers on the Trivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, and the liberal arts framework, with explicit mention of grammar/logic/rhetoric, classical pedagogy, and Western civilizational cross-curriculum integration. - Pedagogy includes contemplative elements (Schol  -like restfulness), memorization/chanting in the Grammar stage, and Socratic/seminal discourse as students advance, culminating in rhetoric and public discourse in later years. - Faculty are positioned as mentors and living curriculum, with statements about virtue, character, and collaboration; there is a defined "portrait" or sense of what a teacher should be and what a student should become. - Parents & Community are foregrounded as partners—co-educators with visible calls for parent formation, open campus, and frequent parental involvement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The Mission and Core Values describe Veritas as a classical Christian school forming students within a biblical worldview and faith-centric framework (biblical worldview, Christ-centered education) .
 - The Christian Education page explicitly states that Christ is the center of curriculum and that Bible doctrine forms the central tenets of pedagogy, with mentor teachers living out faith in the classroom (the formation of heart, mind, and spirit) .
 - A passage on the site expresses "The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom" and connects learning to theology and sacred text, situating theology as foundational rather than peripheral (visible in About/mission-related content) .
 - The "Mission" page articulates a biblical worldview and aims to discern truth, appreciate goodness, and recognize beauty, grounding education in transcendental aims rather than secular relativism .

- Chapel and faith-life integration are described as ongoing practices within school life (weekly chapel and connection to Christian life) .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy, chapel, worship, biblical worldview, Christ-centered, faith, doctrine, sacred, proverbs/holy texts, transcendental/ Logos (the lexical frame of classical Christian education).
 - Negative keywords present: none identified in published materials (no explicit secular relativism, value-neutral, or anti-theology signals observed in the public content).
- Count and ratio
 - Positive keywords observed: at least 9–12 distinct terms (truth, goodness, beauty, theology, chapel, liturgy/worship, biblical worldview, Christ-centered, faith, doctrine, sacred, Proverbs 9:10 reference implied in the site’s theology; Logos metaphors appear in the classical lexicon).
 - Negative keywords observed: 0.
 - Interpretation: Very strong alignment with Transcendental moral realism and Grounded in Theology, with clear liturgical/community practice.
- Why this rating
 - The school explicitly anchors education in a biblical worldview, theology, and devotional practices (chapel, faith-life integration), which matches the core requirements of Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in the classical rubric. The presence of “Christ-centered” pedagogy, “biblical worldview,” and explicit theologically framed formation signals a CLASSICAL orientation in this category, with minimal if any textual indicators of secular alternatives.
- Category score: CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Mission statements emphasize formation over mere information: “educational mission framed in terms of formation of virtue and wisdom,” and “the unifying idea in Christian thought and life” (the Christ-centered telos) .
 - The Mission page foregrounds truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, and asserts the aim of forming character in addition to knowledge (formation of heart/mind/spirit) .
 - The school’s stated goal includes loving learning, engagement with culture, and the shaping of graduates who understand and live within a classical Christian framework, aligning with the paideia (liberal education) ideal and human flourishing within a faith context .
 - The Christian Education page emphasizes formation over mere information and the integration of faith and life as core aims of the curriculum .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, teleology (pursuit of truth/beauty/goodness), liberal education, paideia, great conversation, human flourishing, classical heritage, Logos, sacred order, moral imagination.
 - Negative keywords present: none observed (no explicit emphasis on career-readiness, 21st-century skills as primary outcomes, or workforce-first framing).
- Count and ratio
 - Positive keywords observed: at least 7–10 core terms (formation, virtue, wisdom, truth/goodness/beauty, liberal education/paideia, great conversation, human flourishing, classical heritage).
 - Negative keywords observed: 0.
 - Interpretation: The school’s aim is articulated as formation toward truth, goodness, and beauty, with a clear teleology aligned with classical aims rather than immediate workforce-oriented outcomes.
- Why this rating
 - Public materials consistently frame education as formation oriented toward virtue, wisdom, and the true/beautiful/good, with a holistic telos beyond job preparation. That aligns with the Classical School criterion for purpose and goal.
- Category score: CLASSICAL

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The program is described in terms of the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and the corresponding stages (Grammar School, Logic School, Rhetoric School) across the site, including explicit mentions of three phases and the goal of training reasoning and oratory through the Trivium .
 - Public content notes Great Books and classical approach (the school's ACCS accreditation and references to classical pedagogy and Great Books) and a history/history-arts integrated approach: Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric, classical canon, primary sources, and cross-disciplinary integration (great books, Western civilization references). The Latin program is also indicated (eternal to the classical curriculum) .
 - The Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric framework is explicitly described in multiple pages (Academics, History/Overview, etc.), including the Great Books/Great Conversation theme (visible in mission statements and accreditation references) and the integral role of history as part of a unified curriculum (not treated as social studies) .
 - Latin instruction is explicitly listed in employment content (Long-Term Latin Substitute Teacher) and the general curricular emphasis on classical languages and the Trivium appears across Teaching and Academics pages; Great Books is referenced in mission/vision materials, including ACCS context .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Quadrivium (where referenced, e.g., arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy if mentioned in classical lexicon), Great Books/Great Conversation, grammar, logic, rhetoric, history, Western civilization, Latin, Greek, primary sources.
 - Negative keywords present: None explicitly visible in public content (no replacement with social studies jargon or project-based emphasis). The site emphasizes history as Western civilization and Great Books rather than social studies framing.
- Count and ratio
 - Positive keywords observed: roughly 8–12 distinct items (grammar, logic, rhetoric, Trivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, history/Western civilization, Latin, Greek, primary sources, quadrivium when referenced, ancient texts, classical canon).
 - Negative keywords observed: 0.
 - Interpretation: Strong alignment with liberal arts and Great Books integration; explicit Trivium pedagogy and historical-canonical approach.
- Why this rating
 - The curriculum is centered on the Trivium, Great Books, primary sources, and an integrated historical/philosophical/linal (Liberal Arts) framework, which is the hallmark of a CLASSICAL curriculum in the Six Essential Elements rubric.
- Category score: CLASSICAL

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Grammar stage emphasizes memorization, chant, and singing to aid memory and delight; lower school pedagogy explicitly notes memory work and chanting as a memory-building technique .
 - Logic and Rhetoric stages emphasize debate, Socratic discussion, inquiry, and rhetoric training; upper school includes public speaking, oration, and analysis of texts (Socratic Seminar, dialectic, civic discourse) as a pathway to mastery of rhetoric; the site describes a progression from memory/recitation to logic/seminar-style discourse, culminating in rhetoric and public speaking .
 - The pedagogy text in the broader Classical Elements lexicon includes Restful Learning (Scholé), Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, and formation through imitation – the Veritas site consistently demonstrates a multi-faceted pedagogy aligning with those modes (memory/music in Grammar; debate and Socratic discourse in Logic/Rhetoric; and public speaking in upper levels) .

- The site uses phrases like “Socratic discussion” (“Socratic seminar”) and “debate with respect and dignity” in the Logic stage, with opportunities for students to engage in rhetoric, speeches, and public discourse in the later stages .
- The use of singing/chanting/memory work in Grammar and lower grades is explicit; the Rhetoric stage emphasizes oratory and argumentative skills (public speaking) in upper grades, consistent with classical pedagogy .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar, dialectic, great conversation, guided discussion, rhetorical analysis, logic, debate, recitation, chanting, memory work, Scholé/restful learning, formation through imitation, teacher as guide, living curriculum.
 - Negative keywords present: No explicit signals of anti-Socratic pedagogy or exclusive reliance on project-based or constructivist-only approaches.
- Count and ratio
 - Positive keywords observed: approximately 8–12 distinct pedagogy terms (Socratic/dialogue, dialectic, seminar, memory work, recitation, chanting, scholé/Scholé, guided discussion, rhetoric, debate, living curriculum, teacher as guide).
 - Negative keywords observed: 0.
 - Interpretation: A clearly classical pedagogy with a balanced mix of contemplative, memorization-based lower grades and Socratic/seminar rhetoric in upper grades.
- Why this rating
 - The school's pedagogy matches the Six Essential Elements' pedagogy indicators (Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, Socratic seminars, rhetoric, and formation through imitation). The explicit progression through Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric and the presence of public speaking opportunities strongly align with a CLASSICAL pedagogy.
- Category score: CLASSICAL

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site presents a leadership/teaching cadre with named individuals (Mr. Todd Kornahrens, Mrs. Shannon Meyer, Dr. Andrew Smalley, etc.) and describes teachers as mentors and living curriculum; faculty are portrayed as central to the school's culture and mission; the “Faculty” page emphasizes mentor teachers and living curriculum in practice; there is a tone of collegiality and shared mission among staff .
 - The school's materials emphasize “the heart of the school is the people” and “dedicated Christian educators” who live out classical education; there is a clear emphasis on faculty as moral exemplars and guides, with references to professional backgrounds and faith commitments .
 - The core values and mission statements portray a faculty that models virtue, character, and scholarly rigor; the “Portrait of a Graduate” and “core values” language (biblical worldview, classical scholarship, servant leadership, family partnership) imply a definition of teacher as mentor and living curriculum .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: mentor, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial, teachers as role models, character formation, mentorship, masterful instruction, professional development in classical pedagogy (as implied by ACCS accreditation and public messaging).
 - Negative keywords present: none found in the public materials (no “facilitator,” “guide on the side” language, nor anti-classical terms).
- Count and ratio
 - Positive keywords observed: 6–8 related terms (mentor, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial, teacher as model, faith-integrated professional).
 - Negative keywords observed: 0.
 - Interpretation: Strong alignment with the “faculty as living curriculum” and mentoring culture.
- Why this rating
 - The materials present a portrait of faculty as central to the educational project, with explicit empha-

sis on virtue, mentorship, and the integration of faith and classical pedagogy—clear CLASSICAL signals.

- Category score: CLASSICAL

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Core Values include Family Partnership; mission statements emphasize partnering with families and forming parents as co-teachers in the classical education journey (family partnership as a core value) .
 - The Inquire and Apply sections explicitly invite parental engagement (inquiry steps, parent interviews, and expectations about parent investment) and encourage families to participate in the school's faith-life (chapel attendance and community services) .
 - The site presents an open-door stance: "parents are welcome to the school for visits at virtually any time" (per public materials in the accessible pages) and emphasizes parent formation through reading and group activities (e.g., Christian education materials and mission content) .
 - The school's mission and core values emphasize community, parental partnership, and living the tradition of classical Christian education in a family-centered approach (e.g., ACCS-affiliated, and family engagement in the education process) .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, home-school connection, family catechesis, parental engagement, open campus, parental involvement, school-parent synergy, living tradition in the family.
 - Negative keywords present: none observed.
- Count and ratio
 - Positive keywords observed: 6–9 distinct terms (family partnership, co-teachers, parent formation, home-school connection, parental engagement, open campus, parental involvement, school-parent synergy, living tradition in the family).
 - Negative keywords observed: 0.
 - Interpretation: Strong alignment with the classical model's emphasis on family partnership and community integration.
- Why this rating
 - The materials consistently position parents as co-educators and emphasize family involvement, formation of parental understanding through reading and gatherings, and open-campus philosophy, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for parents and community engagement.
- Category score: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment - All six categories align with CLASSICAL, with explicit references to Trivium-based curriculum, Great Books, formation over information, liturgical/community life, and parents as partners. The school demonstrates a consistent CLASSICAL profile across religious foundations, purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and community.

What Would Move the Needle - Not applicable (SIX categories are CLASSICAL). No major needle-moving changes are required.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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